> the factory proletariat' (*The Times*, May 1921). Since then, they never dared to approach them. . . . The Bardoli resolution of 1922 clearly defines the horror the leaders felt when they saw the gigantic peasant class rising to shake off not only the domination of an alien nation but also the yoke of the landlords. [6]

So critical was Bhagat Singh of this stance that he added how 'it is here that our leaders prefer a surrender to the British than to the peasantry'. He demanded bitterly,

> Apart from Pt. Jawahar Lal can you point to any leader, who made any effort to organise the peasants or the labourers? No, they will not run the risk. There they lack. That is why I say they never meant a complete revolution. Through economic and administrative pressure they hoped to get a few more reforms [from the British], a few more concessions for the Indian capitalists. That is why I say that this movement is doomed to die . . .[7]

It is interesting to see here how similar this view is to that of Fanon. Like Bhagat Singh, who criticized Gandhi, Fanon also wrote, 'The politicians who make speeches and who write in the nationalist newspapers make people dream dreams. They avoid the actual overthrowing of the State . . .'[8]

Bhagat Singh ultimately disagreed with Gandhi's satyagraha (a policy of passive political resistance). In an essay written in Punjabi in June 1928, when he was on the editorial board of *Kirti*, he explained why. This was the year when the biggest satyagraha was being held by the peasants of Bardoli (in Gujarat). He wrote, 'After every thirty years taxes are revised and every time the tax on the land is raised.' He continued, 'The same thing happened this year as well and the tax has been hiked . . . But what are the people to do?' The problem was acute because '[t]he peasant in any case is not able to fill his belly and how can he pay 22% more tax than before?'. As the preparations were made for satyagraha, he notes how 'Mahatma Gandhi corresponded with the Governor of Punjab to try and get the tax reduced, but Sir, this government is not about to bend only through letters. It had no effect'.

The same thing had happened some years earlier when 'in 1917-18 the crop had rotted due to excessive rains and was not even worth one fourth of the price of the normal crop'. Since '[t]he law stated that tax would not be collected if the crop was less than six annas worth in a rupee,' the people